ZAGA

ZAGA is a Montreal-based music producer, DJ, multidisciplinary artist and all-round technomancer who likes to experiment with innovative sound design and composition,

For Timeless, we are proposing an eclectic set of original music, which ranges from melodic house, through bass house, to harmonically rich and surprising drum and bass.

ZAGA's music is futuristic, psychedelic, cerebral and keeps surprising the listener with new and interesting sounds.

ZAGA makes electronic music in a wide variety of genres, as well as animations, games and open source audio software.

An example set of originals can be found at **https://soundcloud.com/zaga/psybernetic**

Selected released tracks can be found on **Bandcamp**, and a further selection of older tracks on **Soundcloud**, An independent personal page is at **ZAGA.MUSIC**.

In his other endeavors, he leads the development of an open source alternative to hearing aids. His influences include a lifelong passion for music and sound, science fiction, and an involvement in hacker culture and electronic music underground.

EXPERIMENTAL ***SOUND DESIGN***

ZAGA uses innovative sound design techniques in all music projects. For example, both of the tracks on the right use a tuning of individual harmonic frequencies, as well as wavetable synthesis, glitch effects, and resynthesis.

Technomancer, above, takes advantage of psychoacoustics to make you hallucinate a melody. We're probably hearing the same one though. Probably. The full song can be experienced interactively at **cubetopia.art/BPM**.

Sequence, below, also tunes atonal harmonics, this time to a chord progression. The video features a real-time particle synth which can be live-synched to the music. These and other songs can be found on **Bandcamp**.

EPIC ***VISUALS***

ZAGA makes animations and interactive experiences for his music. The style often features fractal art, retro gaming aesthetic and science fiction.

If a set were to be scheduled after dark, we would like to bring a high quality projector, to accompany the set, or if there is already a setup for visuals we would like to supply them.

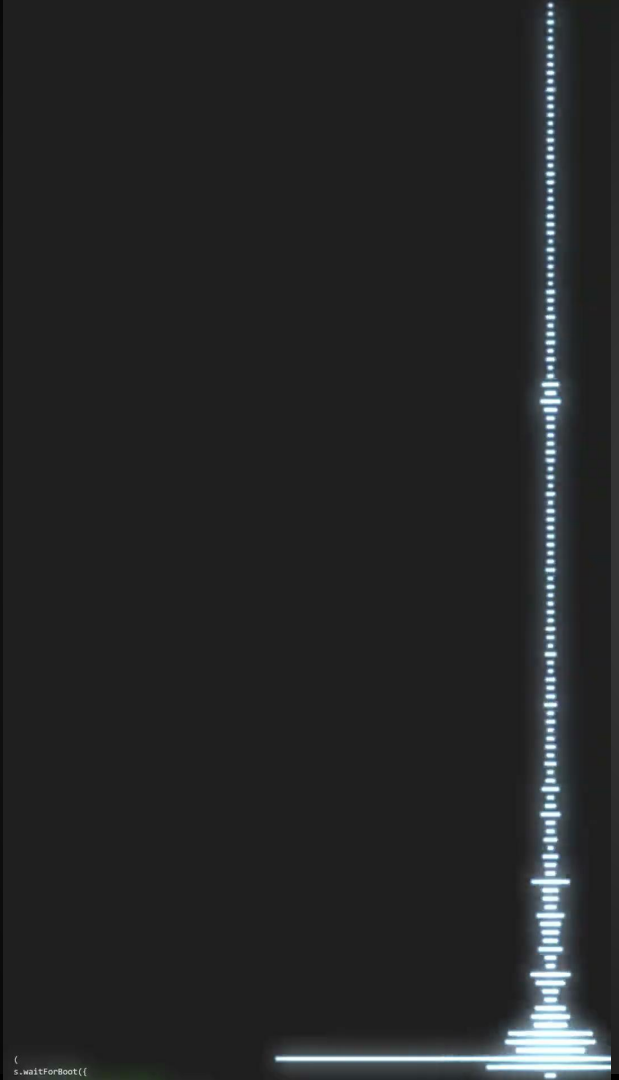
This includes fractal art visuals like the ones on the right.

Some visuals are rendered in the Godot game engine or made with real-time sound reactive shaders.

A selection of these can be found in ZAGA's interactive music experiences available at **https://cubetopia.art/BPM.html**

A sampler of these interactive experiences is shown in the video on the left.

A further showcase of ZAGA visuals is on **YouTube.**



LIVE CODED
MUSIC

ZAGA live codes music, using his experience with sound design and music theory to make it aetherial and original, surprising those who expect music generated from code to be somewhat basic.

The example of ZAGA's algorave melodic techno in the video on the left was written in SuperCollider, and the code reverse-engineers the wave forms of popular synths to achieve this elevated, polished sound. A higher resolution version can be found here: **DOWNLOAD**

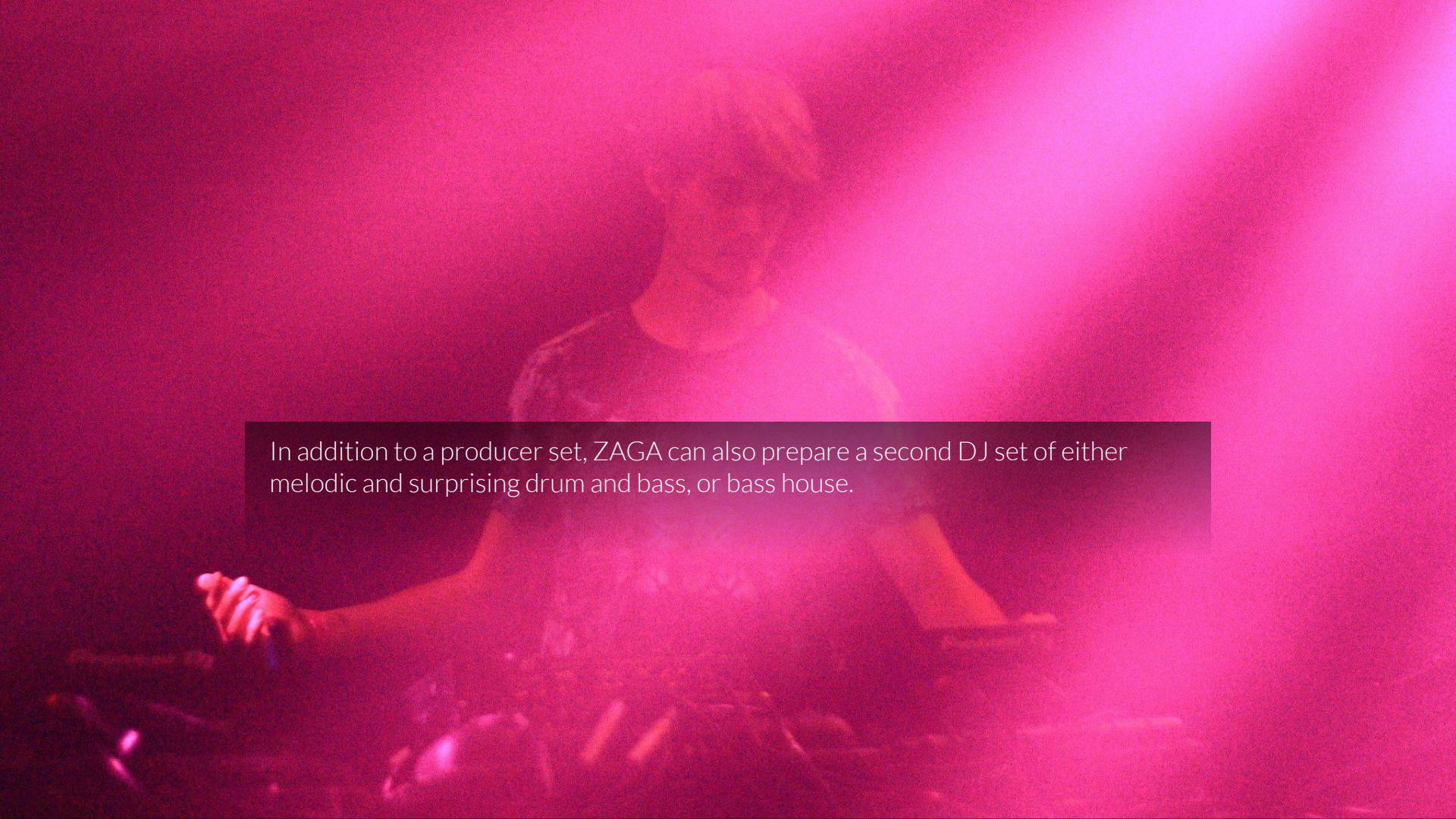
```
// RUMBLE FX: Reverb bass generated from Kick
SynthDef(\rumbleFX, { |inBus, out=0, amp=0.5|
    var input, wet, ducked;
    input = In.ar(inBus, 1);

    // 1. Heavy Reverb
    wet = FreeVerb.ar(input, mix: 1.0, room: 0.9, damp: 0.1);

    // 2. Filter for low end rumble
    wet = LPF.ar(wet, 100);

    // 3. Distortion
    wet = (wet * 3).tanh;

    // 4. Sidechain Ducking (The kick ducks the rumble)
    // Compander: when input (kick) > thresh, compress the wet signal
    ducked = Compander.ar(wet, input,
        thresh: 0.1,
        slopeBelow: 1.0,
        slopeAbove: 0.05, // Crush it when kick hits
        clampTime: 0.002,
        relaxTime: 0.15
    );

    Out.ar(out, Pan2.ar(ducked * amp, 0));
}).add;

// HI-HAT: 909ish
SynthDef(\hat909, { |out=0, amp=0.3, release=0.1|
    var sig, env;
    sig = WhiteNoise.ar;
    sig = HPF.ar(sig, 8000);
    env = EnvGen.ar(Env.perc(0.02, release), doneAction: 2);
    Out.ar(out, Pan2.ar(sig * env * amp, Rand(-0.2, 0.2)));
}).add;

// ACID 303
SynthDef(\acid303, { |out=0, auxBus, send=0, freq=440, gate=1, amp=0.2, cutoff=1000, res=0.2, lag=0.1|
    var sig, env, filt, panned;
    freq = Lag.kr(freq, lag);
    sig = LFSaw.ar(freq);
    env = EnvGen.ar(Env.adsr(0.01, 0.1, 0.6, 0.2), gate, doneAction: 2);

    // Resonant Low Pass
    filt = RLPF.ar(sig, (cutoff * env).clip(50, 18000), res);
    filt = (filt * 2).tanh; // Drive

    panned = Pan2.ar(filt * env, 0);
    Out.ar(out, panned * amp);
    Out.ar(auxBus, panned * send); // Send to FX
}).add;
```

An extensive knowledge of digital synthesis comes in handy here, as just a few lines of code recreate the sound of popular hardware synths such as the Roland TB-303 from frequency information.

In practice, for a live performance some synth definitions are pre-coded to be easily triggered at the beginning of the show, only to be later morphed and modified for a melodic journey.

And it’s not only a journey through sound - but also an eye-opening demonstration of the connection between mathematics and music, that leaves one with a new understanding of the laws of nature.

Live coding can also be used to pass MIDI information to Reaper and trigger synched, pre-synthesized samples and tracks.



In addition to a producer set, ZAGA can also prepare a second DJ set of either melodic and surprising drum and bass, or bass house.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR CONSIDERATION!

The audience rioting for an encore after a ZAGA show (video).